In 2018, RSS Sarsanghchalak Mohan Bhagwat publicly announced that even parts of *Bunch of Thoughts* were not representative of the Sangh's current views. Talking specifically to the parts where Golwalkar referred to Muslims as enemies, Bhagwat responded that '*Bunch of Thoughts* is a collection of speeches made in a particular context and cannot be eternally valid. Sangh is not dogmatic. Times change, and accordingly our thoughts transform. Dr Hedgewar, RSS founder, said we are free to adapt to times as they change. Sangh acknowledges as valid only those parts of *Bunch of Thoughts* which remain relevant in the current circumstance and have been put together in an in-house publication on Golwalkar, *Guruji: Vision and Mission*.'[19]

So, where does the RSS stand today on key cultural flashpoints? It is essential to understand that it sees Hindutva, Hinduism and Bharatiyata (Indianness) as essentially the same thing. For its opponents, Hinduism is politically perverted in the RSS's version of Hindutva, which has been reinventing a variegated collection of multiple beliefs as a unitary identity from the nineteenth century onwards.[20] In other words, it was a political project that sought to reconstruct Hinduism. For the RSS, on the other hand, Hindutva is the core tradition that has bound India for centuries and the thread that bound religious figures as diverse as Ram, Parashuram, Krishna and Buddha to later historical figures as diverse as Shivaji, Vivekananda, Ambedkar, Tagore and Gandhi. All of these icons, in the RSS's view, were proponents of Hindutva.

Mohan Bhagwat illustrated this viewpoint in 2018, in a rare interview to *Organiser*, with the cover-page title 'Hindutva Is One'. To a question on the difference between the original Hindutva versus more aggressive versions of it, the sarsanghchalak answered that the term 'Hindutva' encapsulated several eternal values that the Sangh believed in: 'Satya (Truthfulness), Ahimsa (Non-violence), Asteya (not stealing), Aparigrah (non-possessiveness), Brahmacharya (consciousness of a higher ideal), Tap (Austerity), Shouch (Purity), Santosh (contentment) and Ishwara-Pranidhana (Surrender to Almighty).' Crucially, Bhagwat invoked the Mahatma. 'Gandhi Ji also talked about a consistent search for Truth, that Truth is Hindutva,' he said. Then he mentioned a range of nationalist